Highlights

Thermal-Crosstalk-Aware Scheduling and Model Predictive Dynamic Voltage and Frequency Scaling for Spaceborne Multi-Chip AI Clusters in Deep Vacuum

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- Non-linear CTM network and EKF state estimation under deep orbital vacuum.
- Constrained LTV MPC-DVFS via warm-started ADMM solves thermal crosstalk.
- Dynamic radiative power budgeting derived from predicted orbital flux.
- 3-orbit simulation exhibits zero threshold violations and 77.6% gradient drop.
- LHS robustness ($n = 30$) demonstrates reliable containment under uncertainty.

Thermal-Crosstalk-Aware Scheduling and Model Predictive Dynamic Voltage and Frequency Scaling for Spaceborne Multi-Chip AI Clusters in Deep Vacuum

Dafnhê T. C. M. Barros[a,*], Flávio B. Braz da Silva[a]

[a]Graduate Program in Control and Automation Engineering (ProPECAut), Federal Institute of Espírito Santo (IFES), Rodovia BR-101 Norte, Km 58, Serra, 29166-064, Espírito Santo, Brazil

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ABSTRACT

High-density heterogeneous artificial intelligence (AI) computing clusters onboard small satellites in Low Earth Orbit (LEO) face severe electrothermal constraints. Gas-mediated convective heat transfer is neglected in the adopted high-vacuum model ($h \approx 0$), confining thermal rejection exclusively to internal solid conduction and non-linear Stefan-Boltzmann radiation to deep space ($q \propto T^4$). In multi-chip modules (MCM), heavy neural inference workloads induce severe lateral conductive coupling between adjacent silicon dies (*thermal crosstalk*). This paper investigates a model-based predictive thermal management strategy, denoted **TCAS-DVFS** (*Thermal-Crosstalk-Aware Scheduling and Model Predictive Dynamic Voltage and Frequency Scaling*), formulated from lumped thermodynamic principles for multi-die spaceborne accelerators. The proposed architecture integrates: (i) real-time state estimation via an Extended Kalman Filter (EKF) operating over a non-linear 5×5 Compact Thermal Model (CTM); (ii) a discrete linear time-varying Model Predictive Controller (LTV MPC-DVFS) that solves a condensed quadratic program via a warm-started ADMM-style splitting iteration, coordinating operating frequencies; (iii) a dynamic temperature-referenced radiative power-budget surrogate derived from orbital ephemerides and ambient flux forecasts; and (iv) a topological task allocator relaxed over the semidefinite cone $\mathbb{S}_+^{17}$ via Semidefinite Programming (SDP). In a three-orbit numerical co-simulation of a 500-km circular LEO scenario (17,004.0 s, 34,009 time samples, 4 processing dies), TCAS-DVFS produced zero observed junction temperature violations above the 85 °C threshold (0 s versus 200.5 s for binary Thermal Throttling at 85/75 °C and 14.0 s for Space-PID), attenuated peak inter-die thermal gradients by 77.6% (reducing from 9.42 to 2.11 K), and maintained an aggregate throughput of 124.38 FPS with an energy-delay product proxy ($E_{t_{\text{frame}}}$) of 7.477 kJ·s/frame. Functional ablation indicates a dominant contribution from the predictive control formulation in damping gradients and bounding temperatures, whereas topological SDP scheduling provides limited observed benefits in compact arrangements ($N = 4$ dies) due to conductive symmetry. Sensitivity was evaluated under a 30-sample Latin Hypercube Sampling (LHS) stress-test envelope ($\pm 20\%$ parameter variation), yielding zero observed violations with an exact 95% Clopper-Pearson upper confidence bound of 11.57%, where die-to-radiator thermal resistance (R_r) exhibited the strongest monotonic association with $T_{\max}$ (Spearman $\rho = +0.994$). Indicative reliability proxy analyses demonstrate that electromigration yields no life extension (relative Black damage ratios of 0.96 and 0.81), whereas cyclic thermal stress severity is noticeably damped. The reported evidence is limited to numerical simulation of the stated lumped-parameter model and does not constitute hardware or flight qualification.

1. Introduction

1.1. Orbital Edge Computing and Spaceborne AI

Modern Earth Observation (EO) satellite missions, including wildfire monitoring, maritime surveillance, disaster response, and Synthetic Aperture Radar (SAR) imaging, produce massive data streams operating at multi-gigabit-per-second rates in Low Earth Orbit (LEO) (Denby and Lucia, 2020; Garrett et al., 2024; Chen, 2026). Traditionally, remote sensing platforms have relied on the conventional *store-and-forward* architecture, wherein raw payload data are captured, buffered in solid-state recorders, and downlinked during brief 8-to-12-minute ground-station passes per orbit. This approach incurs severe latency penalties, frequently exceeding 4 to 12 hours (Denby and Lucia, 2020; Garrett et al., 2024).

Edge artificial intelligence (AI) onboard small satellites mitigates this downlink bottleneck by processing, compressing, and triaging sensor data directly in orbit using commercial off-the-shelf (COTS) neural accelerators, multicore ARM CPUs, and embedded GPUs (Garrett et al., 2024; Sherwood et al., 2003). In particular, automated on-orbit cloud segmentation enables the autonomous discarding of up to 67% of optically obstructed imagery prior to transmission (King et al., 2013), thereby conserving scarce communication bandwidth for high-priority mission products (Giuffrida et al., 2021).

1.2. Deep Vacuum Thermodynamics and Thermal Crosstalk

Unlike terrestrial data centers that leverage forced air convection ($h \approx 20$–100 W/(m^{2}K)) or pumped liquid cooling loops ($h \approx 1{,}000$–$10{,}000$ W/(m^{2}K)) (Bergman et al.,

*Corresponding author.
dafnhe.barros@msn.com (Dafnhê T. C. M. Barros);
flavio.silva@ifes.edu.br (Flávio B. Braz da Silva)
ORCID(s): 0009-0004-9840-0257 (Dafnhê T. C. M. Barros);
0000-0002-4752-9742 (Flávio B. Braz da Silva)

2011), small spacecraft operating in the high vacuum of LEO ($P < 10^{-4}$ Pa, free molecular flow with Knudsen number $Kn \gg 10$) (Gilmore, 2002) exhibit negligible convective gas exchange. Consequently, gas-mediated convective heat transfer is neglected in the adopted high-vacuum model ($h \approx 0$). Thermal rejection from energized silicon junctions is restricted to two coupled mechanisms (European Cooperation for Space Standardization, 2008; Gilmore, 2002):

1. **Internal solid conduction:** heat dissipates from active junctions across thermal interface materials (TIM) into a shared cold plate or metallic carrier (e.g., AlN or Al 6061-T6, $k \approx 170$–200 W/(m · K)) (European Cooperation for Space Standardization, 2008). Direct radiative exchange between facing die sidewalls is negligible ($< 10^{-3}$ W due to microscopic lateral areas $A_{lat} \approx 10^{-5}$ m^2 and small temperature differences).
2. **External radiation to deep space:** structural heat reaches outer passive radiators and is radiated to the cold cosmic background ($T_{space} \approx 2.73$ K) governed by the non-linear Stefan-Boltzmann law ($q_{rad} \propto \varepsilon\sigma T^4$) (Bergman et al., 2011; Pederson et al., 2024).

In compact small-satellite form factors (e.g., 6U–12U CubeSats), volume and mass constraints dictate packaging multiple System-on-Module (SoM) accelerators on a single carrier. Simultaneous deep neural inference workloads dissipate between 10 and 25 W per die (Reuther et al., 2022; Kang and Park, 2025), demanding 60 to 100 W from the electrical power system (EPS). Crucially, lateral conductive flux propagating through the carrier raises the base temperature of neighboring idle or lightly loaded dies by 10 to 18 K within tens of seconds (Chen et al., 2026; Wang et al., 2025). This mutual conductive coupling, termed **spatial thermal crosstalk**, induces mutual thermal interference and severely degrades uncoordinated, decentralized governors.

1.3. Deficiencies of Terrestrial Thermal Governors

Conventional reactive algorithms, such as the Linux *ondemand* governor (Pallipadi and Starikovskiy, 2006) and classical Single-Input Single-Output (SISO) PID loops, fail in orbital clusters due to three structural factors (Brooks and Martonosi, 2001; Skadron et al., 2004; Hoffmann and Fröhlich, 2022):

1. **Large thermal inertia:** passive radiators ($C_{rad} \approx 1{,}300$ J/K) introduce dominant time constants of tens of minutes, causing purely reactive policies to act with critical delay.
2. **Limit-cycle saw-tooth oscillations:** binary frequency throttling upon crossing emergency alarm thresholds triggers repetitive temperature fluctuations ($\Delta T \approx 10$ K).
3. **Spatial gradient amplification:** uncoordinated DVFS across asymmetric workloads exacerbates instantaneous temperature differentials across adjacent dies, accelerating low-cycle thermomechanical shear fatigue in Ball Grid Array (BGA) solder interconnects (Manson, 1966).

1.4. Research Question and Contributions

The pioneering work of Chen et al. (2026) established thermal-crosstalk-aware task scheduling in spaceborne AI clusters. Building on this domain, our work investigates the following research question:

> *Can a model-based coordinated MPC-DVFS policy reduce thermal-threshold exceedance and inter-die temperature gradients in a simulated four-die orbital AI cluster while maintaining competitive inference throughput relative to reactive thermal governors under identical modeled workload and environmental conditions?*

To address this question through model-based numerical simulation, this paper presents the following contributions and findings within the scope of the modeled multi-physics system:

1. **Non-linear State-Space Electrothermal Modeling:** we formulate a 5×5 compact thermal network (CTM) capturing conductive coupling matrices, linearized Stefan-Boltzmann radiator dynamics, and non-linear subthreshold leakage positive feedback, integrated with an Extended Kalman Filter (EKF) observer under stochastic sensor noise.
2. **Constrained Predictive Control (LTV MPC-DVFS):** we formulate a discrete linear time-varying Model Predictive Controller that solves a condensed quadratic programming problem via a warm-started ADMM-style splitting iteration, coordinating operating frequencies to track inference workloads, enforce a nominal 83 °C limit, and suppress spatial gradients.
3. **Orbital Radiative Power Budget Surrogate:** we derive a predictive moving-average budget for solar flux, terrestrial albedo, and Earth infrared radiation to establish a temperature-referenced power envelope under eclipse transitions.
4. **Numerical Robustness and Methodological Demarcation:** we execute a three-orbit numerical co-simulation, functional ablation, a 30-sample Latin Hypercube Sampling (LHS) stress-test campaign with exact Clopper-Pearson coverage bounds, and physics-of-failure reliability proxy evaluations.

To ensure complete methodological transparency, Table 1 establishes the explicit demarcation between input assumptions, synthetic drivers, calculated simulation states, evaluated proxies, and physically unmeasured quantities.

The remainder of this article is organized as follows: Section 2 presents the orbital environmental physics and radiative balance. Section 3 derives the electrothermal state-space model. Section 4 develops the TCAS-DVFS control architecture. Section 5 details the co-simulation methodology. Section 6 presents comparative simulation results, ablation, and parametric sensitivity. Section 7 evaluates indicative reliability proxies. Section 8 discusses related work, Section 9 discusses practical implementation considerations and threats to validity, and Section 10 concludes the paper.

Table 1
Methodological Demarcation of Study Elements

Methodological Category	Specific Elements in this Study
Input Physical Parameters	Conductive resistances R_{ij}, die-to-radiator resistance R_r, die capacitances c_i, radiator capacitance C_{rad}, optical emissivity ε, solar absorptivity α_s (Table 2)
Model Hypotheses & Structure	Lumped-parameter 5×5 CTM; gas conduction neglected ($h\approx0$); linearized radiative state coupling; planar symmetry
Synthetic Workload Inputs	Continuous activity factors $\alpha_i(t)$ and nominal requested frequencies $f_{nom,i}(t)$ across 4 mission workloads
Model Environmental Forcing	Direct solar flux $Q_{sol}(t)$, Earth albedo $Q_{alb}(t)$, and terrestrial infrared $Q_{IR}(t)$ across a 500-km circular orbit
Calculated State Variables	Physical silicon junction temperatures $T_i(t)$ $(i=1,\ldots,4)$ and radiator core temperature $T_{rad}(t)$
Estimated State Variables	EKF state estimates $\hat{T}_i(t)$ and $\hat{T}_{rad}(t)$ reconstructed from noisy sensor measurements ($\sigma_s=0.25$ K)
Actuation Control Variables	Operating clock frequencies $\mathbf{f}(t)=[f_1(t),\ldots,f_4(t)]^T\in[0.30,1.30]$ GHz
Direct Numerical Outputs	Maximum temperature $T_{\max}$, spatial gradient $\Delta T_{esp}(t)$, violation time $t_{>85}$, total energy E
Evaluated Computational Proxies	Aggregate throughput proxy FPS, energy-delay product proxy $E_{t_{\text{frame}}}$, relative Black electromigration damage ratio, thermal-history rainflow cycle distribution
Unmeasured Physical Quantities	Physical component service life, BGA viscoplastic solder strain, internal package microgradients, space radiation effects (TID/SEE), and flight qualification

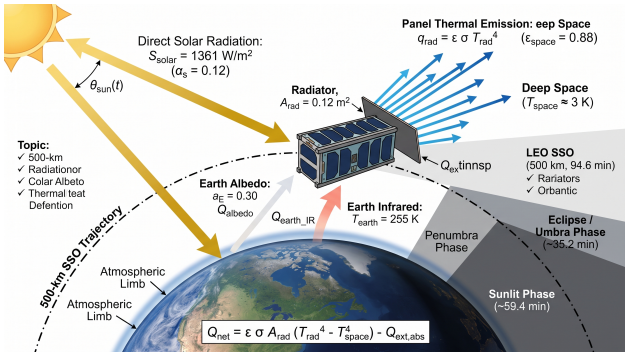


Figure 1: Synthetic 500 km circular LEO orbital geometry (Sun-Synchronous Orbit inclination $i\approx97.4^\circ$, solar beta angle $\beta=0^\circ$): direct solar flux, Earth albedo, terrestrial infrared emission, eclipse cone, and deep space radiator rejection. Conceptual rendering.

2. Orbital Environmental Physics and Heat Balance

2.1. External Orbital Radiative Fluxes

We consider a synthetic circular low Earth orbit thermal scenario at altitude $h=500$ km ($R=R_E+h=6{,}871$ km), with analytical orbital period $T_{orb}=5{,}668.14$ s (≈94.47 min). Defining the orbital phase as $\varphi=\mathrm{mod}(t,T_{orb})/T_{orb}$, the illuminated orbital fraction is $\varphi_{sol}=1-\arcsin(R_E/R)/\pi$ under the conservative assumption of solar beta angle $\beta=0^\circ$ (which maximizes eclipse duration and thermal shock amplitudes). With orbital solar noon at $\varphi_m=\varphi_{sol}/2$ and a smooth illumination operator $\mathbb{I}_{sun}(t)=[1+e^{120(\varphi-\varphi_{sol})}]^{-1}$, the absorbed radiative fluxes on a radiator of area A_{rad} (Fig. 1) are given by:

$$\cos\theta_{ef}(t)=\max\left[0,\ \cos\left(\frac{\pi(\varphi-\varphi_m)}{2\varphi_m}\right)\cos30^\circ\cos15^\circ\right], \tag{1}$$

$$Q_{sol}(t)=\mathbb{I}_{sun}(t)\,S_{solar}\,\alpha_s A_{rad}\cos\theta_{ef}(t), \tag{2}$$

$$Q_{alb}(t)=\mathbb{I}_{sun}(t)\,S_{solar}\,a_E\,\alpha_s A_{rad}F\cos\theta_{ef}(t), \tag{3}$$

$$Q_{IR}(t)=\varepsilon\sigma A_{rad}F\,T_E^4(t), \tag{4}$$

$$T_E(t)=255-15\sin^2\left(\pi\frac{\varphi-\varphi_m}{\varphi_{sol}}\right), \tag{5}$$

where $S_{solar}=1{,}361$ W/m^2 is the solar constant, $a_E=0.30$ is the mean Earth albedo, $F=0.42$ is the Earth-to-plate radiation view factor, $\alpha_s=0.12$ is solar absorptivity, $\varepsilon=0.88$ is infrared emissivity, and $\sigma=5.67\times10^{-8}$ W/(m^{2}K^4) is the Stefan-Boltzmann constant. Earth albedo is modeled proportionally to the illuminated visible fraction via $\cos\theta_{ef}$, a standard conservative approximation in spacecraft thermal engineering (European Cooperation for Space Standardization, 2008; Gilmore, 2002). The total external flux $Q_{ext}(t)=Q_{sol}(t)+Q_{alb}(t)+Q_{IR}(t)$ varies between 8.34 W (in eclipse) and 29.09 W (solar noon), with an orbital mean of 16.84 W.

2.2. Passive Radiator Lumped Dynamics

The thermal energy conservation equation for the radiator panel of mass m_{rad} and specific heat $c_{p,rad}$ ($C_{rad}=m_{rad}c_{p,rad}=1{,}299.2$ J/K) is governed by:

$$C_{rad}\frac{dT_{rad}}{dt}=\sum_{i=1}^{N}\frac{T_i-T_{rad}}{R_r}+Q_{ext}(t) - \varepsilon\sigma A_{rad}\left(T_{rad}^4-T_{space}^4\right), \tag{6}$$

where $R_r=2.10$ K/W represents the equivalent solid conductive thermal resistance between each die node and the radiator core.

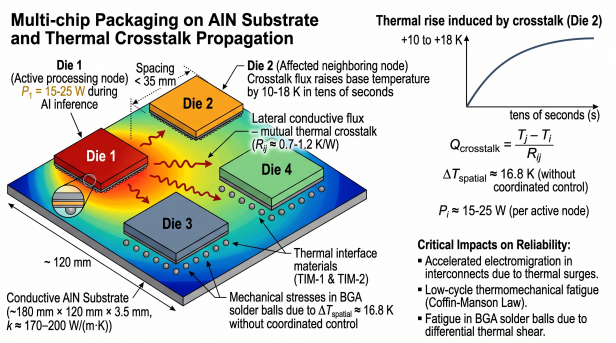


Figure 2: Solid conductive coupling and lateral thermal crosstalk in a multi-die carrier: heat dissipation in one node elevates base temperatures of adjacent dies and induces thermomechanical stress in BGA joints. Conceptual rendering.

3. State-Space Electrothermal Modeling

3.1. Silicon Power Dissipation and Leakage Feedback

Each silicon die (Fig. 2) dissipates electrical power partitioned into dynamic switching and subthreshold leakage components:

$$V_i = \mathrm{clip}(V_{min} + \beta_v(f_i - f_{min}), V_{min}, V_{max}), \quad (7)$$

$$P_{dyn,i} = \alpha_i C_{eff} V_i^2 f_i, \quad (8)$$

$$P_{leak,i} = P_{ref}\left(\frac{V_i}{V_0}\right)^{1.5}\left(\frac{T_i}{T_0}\right)^2 \exp\left[\frac{E_a}{k_B}\left(\frac{1}{T_0} - \frac{1}{T_i}\right)\right], \quad (9)$$

where total power is $P_i = P_{dyn,i} + P_{leak,i}$, with α_i denoting active workload factor, $C_{eff} = 24.5$ nF the effective switching capacitance, and $\beta_v = (V_{max} - V_{min})/(f_{max} - f_{min})$. Leakage power $P_{leak,i}$ exhibits a quadratic-exponential dependence on absolute junction temperature T_i, introducing non-linear positive electrothermal feedback ($\partial P_{leak}/\partial T_i > 0$) and a risk of thermal runaway in the absence of active intervention. Nominal parameters reflect commercial 16/12 nm FinFET embedded AI accelerators (Table 2). The subthreshold model is physically validated up to 125 °C; operations above this ceiling are tagged as unphysical extrapolations (†).

3.2. Compact Thermal Network (5×5 CTM)

The planar thermal coupling across an array of $N = 4$ dies mounted on a shared AlN substrate is modeled by a lumped-parameter compact thermal network:

$$c_i \frac{dT_i}{dt} = P_i(t) - \sum_{j \neq i} \frac{T_i - T_j}{R_{ij}} - \frac{T_i - T_{rad}}{R_r}, \quad (10)$$

where $c_i = 18.5$ J/K is the die thermal capacitance. In compact matrix notation:

$$\mathbf{C}\dot{\mathbf{T}} = \mathbf{P} - (\mathbf{G}_{crosstalk} + \mathbf{G}_{rad})\mathbf{T} + \mathbf{G}_{rad} T_{rad} \mathbf{1}_N, \quad (11)$$

where $\mathbf{C} = \mathrm{diag}(c_1, \ldots, c_N)$, $\mathbf{G}_{rad} = R_r^{-1}\mathbf{I}_N$, and $\mathbf{G}_{crosstalk} \in \mathbb{R}^{N \times N}$ is the symmetric conductive Laplacian matrix:

$$[\mathbf{G}_{crosstalk}]_{ij} = \begin{cases} -1/R_{ij}, & i \neq j, \\ \sum_{k \neq i} 1/R_{ik}, & i = j. \end{cases} \quad (12)$$

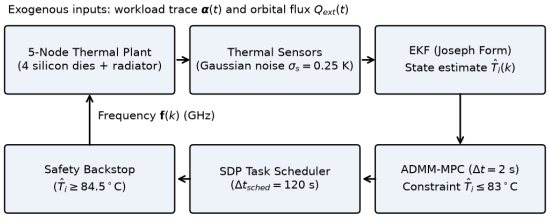


Figure 3: Closed-loop architecture of the TCAS-DVFS framework: non-linear 5×5 CTM plant, EKF state observer, orbital radiative power budgeter, topological SDP scheduler, and constrained discrete LTV MPC-DVFS controller.

Modal decomposition of the die subsystem yields fast thermal time constants of 5.8, 7.5, 7.7, and 38.8 s, contrasting with the slow radiator time constant (1.5–2.1 ks). This pronounced two-time-scale separation provides thermodynamic justification for treating radiator temperature as a quasi-stationary state within the short-horizon predictive controller.

4. Integrated TCAS-DVFS Control Architecture

The closed-loop control architecture (Fig. 3) operates on a multi-rate scheme: continuous physical plant integration and EKF state filtering operate at $\Delta t_{\mathrm{plant}} = 0.5$ s, while model predictive control updates execute every $k_{sub} = 4$ steps ($\Delta t_{\mathrm{MPC}} = 2.0$ s), and topological task allocation updates occur at $\Delta t_{sched} = 120$ s.

4.1. State Estimation via Extended Kalman Filter

The extended state vector $\mathbf{x} = [T_1, T_2, T_3, T_4, T_{rad}]^T \in \mathbb{R}^5$ is measured under zero-mean additive white Gaussian sensor noise: $\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{x} + \mathbf{v}$, $\mathbf{v} \sim \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{0}, \sigma_s^2 \mathbf{I}_5)$, with standard deviation $\sigma_s = 0.25$ K (Zhang and Srivastava, 2011). State propagation and covariance updates employ the stabilized Joseph form (Simon, 2006):

$$\hat{\mathbf{x}}^- = \hat{\mathbf{x}}_{k-1} + \Delta t_{\mathrm{plant}} \mathbf{f}(\hat{\mathbf{x}}_{k-1}, \mathbf{u}_{k-1}), \quad (13)$$

$$\Phi = \mathbf{I}_5 + \Delta t_{\mathrm{plant}} \mathbf{F} + \tfrac{1}{2}(\Delta t_{\mathrm{plant}} \mathbf{F})^2, \quad (14)$$

$$\mathbf{P}^- = \Phi \mathbf{P} \Phi^T + \mathbf{Q} \Delta t_{\mathrm{plant}}, \quad (15)$$

$$\mathbf{K} = \mathbf{P}^-(\mathbf{P}^- + \mathbf{R})^{-1}, \quad \hat{\mathbf{x}} = \hat{\mathbf{x}}^- + \mathbf{K}(\mathbf{y} - \hat{\mathbf{x}}^-), \quad (16)$$

$$\mathbf{P} = (\mathbf{I}_5 - \mathbf{K})\mathbf{P}^-(\mathbf{I}_5 - \mathbf{K})^T + \mathbf{K}\mathbf{R}\mathbf{K}^T, \quad (17)$$

where process noise covariance is $\mathbf{Q} = \mathrm{diag}(0.02\mathbf{I}_4, 0.05)$, measurement noise covariance is $\mathbf{R} = \sigma_s^2 \mathbf{I}_5$, initial error covariance is $\mathbf{P}_0 = \mathrm{diag}(\mathbf{I}_4, 2)$, and Jacobian $\mathbf{F} = \partial \mathbf{f}/\partial \mathbf{x}$ linearizes the Stefan-Boltzmann radiator flux ($g_{rad,lin} = 4\varepsilon\sigma A_{rad} \hat{T}_{rad}^3$). In closed-loop co-simulation, the observer achieves an average junction temperature tracking RMSE below 0.12 K.

4.2. Predictive Radiative Power Budget Surrogate

Using onboard orbital ephemerides over the prediction horizon ($H_p = 30$ steps, 60.0 s), we compute a temperature-referenced radiative power-budget surrogate $P_{bud}(k)$ used as an MPC constraint surrogate to prevent the radiator from driving past steady-state equilibrium:

$$P_{bud}(k) = \max\Big\{15,\ \varepsilon\sigma A_{rad}\big[(T_{seg}+273.15)^4 - T_{space}^4\big] - \bar{Q}_{ext}(k)\Big\}, \tag{18}$$

where $T_{seg} = 83^\circ$C and $\bar{Q}_{ext}(k) = \frac{1}{H_p}\sum_{j=k}^{k+H_p-1} Q_{ext}(j)$ is the predicted moving-average environmental flux.

4.3. Topological Task Scheduler (TCAS)

At task allocation epochs ($\Delta t_{sched} = 120$ s), $M = 4$ incoming neural inference workloads are assigned to the $N = 4$ dies to minimize conductive crosstalk weighted by the steady-state impedance matrix $\blacksquare = (\mathbf{G}_{crosstalk} + \mathbf{G}_{rad})^{-1}$:

$$\min_{\mathbf{X}} \sum_{i=1}^{N}\sum_{j=1}^{N} \Phi_{ij} P_i(\mathbf{X}) P_j(\mathbf{X}) + \mu \sum_{i=1}^{N} (T_i - \bar{T})^2, \tag{19}$$

subject to bijective task assignment constraints $\sum_{i=1}^{N} X_{pi} = 1$ and $\sum_{p=1}^{M} X_{pi} = 1$. Vectorizing the binary assignment decision matrix into $\mathbf{x} = \mathrm{vec}(\mathbf{X}) \in \{0,1\}^{N^2}$ ($n = N^2 = 16$), the Shor semidefinite relaxation lifts the decision variable into the matrix cone:

$$\mathbf{Z} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & \mathbf{x}^T \\ \mathbf{x} & \mathbf{X}_{lift} \end{bmatrix} \in \mathbb{S}_+^{N^2+1} = \mathbb{S}_+^{17}. \tag{20}$$

Candidate discrete allocations are recovered via randomized hyperplane rounding (Boyd and Vandenberghe, 2004). For compact $N = 4$ layouts, the exact permutation space contains $4! = 24$ configurations, permitting exhaustive ex-post validation of the discrete suboptimality gap; however, the SDP rounding procedure does not provide a certified dual lower bound in this implementation.

4.4. Discrete Linear Time-Varying Model Predictive Control (LTV MPC-DVFS)

To coordinate operating frequencies $\mathbf{f}(k) = [f_1, \ldots, f_N]^T$ in real time, the control problem is formulated as a discrete Linear Time-Varying Model Predictive Controller executed at control interval $\Delta t_{\mathrm{MPC}} = 2.0$ s over a control horizon $H_c = 8$ steps (16.0 s) and prediction horizon $H_p = 30$ steps (60.0 s):

$$\min_{\mathbf{f},s} \sum_{j=1}^{H_c} \Big[w\|\mathbf{f}(k+j-1) - \mathbf{f}_{nom}(k+j-1)\|^2 + R_w\|\mathbf{D}\mathbf{f}(k+j-1)\|^2\Big] + \rho \sum_{j=1}^{H_p} \|\tilde{\mathbf{T}}_{grad}(k+j)\|^2 + \lambda s^2, \tag{21}$$

subject to physical and operational constraints:

$$f_{min} \le f_i(k+j) \le f_{max}, \quad \forall i, j, \tag{22}$$

$$T_i(k+j|k) \le T_{cap} + s, \quad s \ge 0, \tag{23}$$

$$\sum_{i=1}^{N} P_i(k+j|k) \le P_{bud}(k+j), \quad \forall j, \tag{24}$$

where $w = 1.0$ penalizes deviation from nominal inference request $\mathbf{f}_{nom}$, $R_w = 0.2$ regularizes frequency change rate via the first-difference operator $\mathbf{D}$, $\rho = 0.02$ penalizes spatial temperature gradients relative to instantaneous spatial mean $\tilde{\mathbf{T}}_{grad} = \mathbf{T} - (\frac{1}{N}\mathbf{1}_N^T\mathbf{T})\mathbf{1}_N$, and $\lambda = 200.0$ penalizes the non-negative scalar thermal constraint slack variable $s \ge 0$ under nominal thermal cap $T_{cap} = 83.0^\circ$C.

The condensed quadratic program is solved using a warm-started ADMM-style splitting method (Boyd et al., 2011; Stellato et al., 2020) with an over-relaxation parameter $\alpha = 1.6$, step size $\rho_{\mathrm{ADMM}} = 1.0$, regularization $\sigma = 10^{-6}$, and a fixed iteration cap of 60 iterations. Convergence tolerances ($\|Ax - z\|_\infty < 2 \times 10^{-3}$) and primal/dual residuals are monitored at each control update. The state trajectory is warm-started using the shifted solution from the preceding control epoch. A fast proportional safety backstop operates at the plant rate ($\Delta t_{\mathrm{plant}} = 0.5$ s), intervening if estimated temperatures exceed 84.5°C to cap frequencies according to $f_i \le f_{nom,i} \max[0.15, (85.0 - T_i)/(85.0 - 75.0)]$.

5. Computational Simulation Methodology

The multi-physics co-simulation platform was developed in Python 3.14 using NumPy, following verification and credibility principles for computational modeling and simulation (NASA, 2022). The numerical simulation contains 34,009 time samples and 34,008 integration intervals of $\Delta t_{\mathrm{plant}} = 0.5$ s integrated via a 2nd-order Runge-Kutta scheme (Heun / RK2), spanning 17,004.0 s, compared with an analytical three-orbit duration of approximately 17,004.43 s ($3 \times 5{,}668.14$ s). A formal temporal convergence study across $\Delta t_{\mathrm{plant}} \in \{1.0, 0.5, 0.25, 0.125\}$ s (with invariant control step $\Delta t_{\mathrm{MPC}} = 2.0$ s) confirmed monotonic convergence: the nominal discretization ($\Delta t = 0.5$ s) incurs an absolute deviation of only 0.155 K in peak junction temperature ($T_{\max} = 83.21^\circ$C vs. 83.06°C at $\Delta t = 0.125$ s), a peak spatial gradient difference under 0.024 K, and a relative total energy variance of 0.23%, remaining well below the sensor measurement noise floor ($\sigma_s = 0.25$ K).

Benchmarking Protocol: To ensure strict methodological parity, all benchmarked governors evaluate:

(i) identical initial states $\mathbf{x}_0$ ($T_{i,0} = 310$ K, $T_{rad,0} = 270$ K);
(ii) identical synthetic inference workload request traces $\mathbf{f}_{nom}(t)$ and activity factors $\alpha(t)$;
(iii) identical modeled orbital environmental radiative forcing $Q_{ext}(t)$;
(iv) identical stochastic sensor noise realizations for any given seed;
(v) identical thermal plant model and integration steps.

Table 2
System Simulation, Electrothermal, and Orbital Parameters

Parameter Category	Symbol & Description	Nominal Value & Source
Conductive Resistances	$R_{12} = R_{34}$, $R_{13} = R_{24}$, $R_{14} = R_{23}$	1.45, 1.52, 3.20 K/W (MCM carrier model) (Wang et al., 2025)
Die-to-Radiator Resistance	R_r (conductive thermal resistance per die node)	2.10 K/W (Cold plate interface) (European Cooperation for Space Standardization, 2008)
Thermal Capacitances	c_i (silicon die node), C_{rad} (radiator core mc_p)	18.5 J/K (FinFET die), 1,299.2 J/K (1.45 kg Al)
Radiator Properties	A_{rad} (area), ε (emissivity), α_s (absorptivity)	0.12 m^2, 0.88 (white paint), 0.12 (Pederson et al., 2024)
Orbital Environment	h (altitude), T_{orb} (period), F (view factor), a_E (albedo)	500 km, 5,668.14 s, 0.42, 0.30 (Gilmore, 2002)
Electrical Operational	V_{min}–V_{max}, f_{min}–f_{max}	0.65–1.05 V, 0.30–1.30 GHz (16/12 nm FinFET)
Leakage Parameters	C_{eff} (capacitance), P_{ref} ($T_0 = 300$ K, $V_0 = 0.85$ V), E_a	24.5 nF, 0.80 W, 0.20 eV (Kang and Park, 2025)
State Observer (EKF)	Sensor noise σ_s, Covariances $\mathbf{Q}$, $\mathbf{P}_0$, $\mathbf{R}$	$\sigma_s = 0.25$ K, $\mathbf{Q} = \mathrm{diag}(0.02, 0.02, 0.02, 0.02, 0.05)$, $\mathbf{R} = \sigma_s^2 \mathbf{I}_5$
MPC Formulation	Δt_{MPC}, H_c, H_p, T_{cap}, T_{bar}, Weights w, R_w, ρ, λ	2.0 s, 8 steps (16 s), 30 steps (60 s), 83.0 °C, 84.5 °C, $w = 1.0, R_w = 0.2, \rho = 0.02, \lambda = 200.0$
Workload Benchmarks	Nominal inference throughputs (FPS_{nom})	SAR-YOLO (45), Cloud-Seg (60), Hyper-ViT (30), Telemetry (80)

Performance and Energy Proxies: Aggregate inference throughput is evaluated via the performance proxy:

$$\mathrm{FPS} = \frac{1}{N_{steps}} \sum_{t} \sum_{i=1}^{N} \frac{f_i(t)}{f_{max}} \mathrm{FPS}_{nom,i}, \tag{25}$$

and aggregate energy efficiency is quantified by the throughput-normalized energy-delay product proxy:

$$E_{t_{\mathrm{frame}}} = E \cdot \frac{1}{\mathrm{FPS}} \quad [\mathrm{kJ} \cdot \mathrm{s/frame}], \tag{26}$$

where $E = \Delta t_{\mathrm{plant}} \sum_t \sum_i P_i(t)$. Instantaneous inter-die spatial gradient is computed as $\Delta T_{esp}(t) = \max_i T_i(t) - \min_i T_i(t)$.

Benchmarked Control Policies:

1. *Linux Ondemand:* standard reactive governor without thermal protection.
2. *Ondemand + trip 95/85:* ondemand governor with emergency trip hysteresis at 95 °C.
3. *Thermal Throttling 85/75:* binary frequency drop to f_{min} upon reaching 85 °C with recovery at 75 °C.
4. *Thermal Throttling 83/73:* conservative baseline matched to the 83 °C design margin.
5. *Space-PID:* decentralized per-die PID controllers with gains selected from a predefined 27-point grid by minimizing an ITAE-based objective augmented with a thermal-violation penalty over the initial tuning interval ($K_p = -0.07$, $K_i = -0.002$, $K_d = -0.04$) set to regulate at 80 °C.
6. *Power Cap 65 W:* static global power budgeting enforced by the EPS.
7. *TCA-DVFS (simple):* uncoordinated Laplacian rule with thermal barrier and radiative budget, excluding MPC and SDP.
8. **TCAS-DVFS (proposed):** full multi-rate architecture integrating EKF, topological SDP task allocation, and warm-started ADMM-based discrete LTV MPC-DVFS.

All simulation source code, experimental pipelines, nominal configuration manifests (`configs/nominal.json`), convergence verification suites, ASTM E1049-85 validation test harnesses, and computational reproducibility metadata (`results/metadata.json`) are organized under an open-source MIT repository structure at `https://github.com/dafnhe-thor-barros/TCAS-DVFS`.

6. Results and Discussion

6.1. Global Performance Comparison

Table 3 presents the consolidated comparative results across 3 full orbits. **TCAS-DVFS** successfully maintained junction temperatures strictly below the 85 °C flight envelope, registering a peak of 83.27°C and **zero observed seconds of thermal violation** (0.00%). In contrast, standard Thermal Throttling 85/75 accumulated 200.5 s of overheating due to hysteresis latency, and Space-PID breached the limit for 14.0 s during the post-eclipse thermal shock.

In terms of processing throughput, TCAS-DVFS delivered 124.38 FPS, outperforming Throttling 85/75 (+4.0%) and conservative Throttling 83/73 (+4.7%), while matching energy-delay efficiency (7.477 kJ · s/frame versus 7.456 kJ ·

Table 3
Consolidated Results in 3-Orbit LEO Co-Simulation (500 km SSO, 34,009 Steps, $\Delta t = 0.5$ s, Seed 0)

Strategy	T_{mean} (°C)	$T_{\max}$ (°C)	ΔT_{peak} (K)	ΔT_{mean} (K)	$t_{>85}$ (s)	FPS	$E_{t_{\text{fr}}}$ (kJ·s/fr)	Energy (kJ)
Linux Ondemand	350.17†	412.30†	12.87	8.64	16,038.0	181.21†	28.38	5,143.3†
Ondemand + trip 95/85	87.96	95.95	9.28	3.93	16,037.5	117.27	8.63	1,011.5
Throttling 85/75	78.08	86.06	9.42	5.26	200.5	119.58	7.57	905.6
Throttling 83/73	76.17	83.78	9.46	5.24	0.0	118.75	7.46	885.4
Space-PID	79.73	85.56	4.88	0.62	14.0	123.24	7.47	920.5
Power Cap (65 W)	93.95	109.31	5.82	3.66	14,983.5	126.49	8.55	1,081.3
TCA-DVFS (simple)	80.53	83.74	1.58	0.45	0.0	116.16	8.03	932.4
TCAS-DVFS (Proposed)	**80.28**	**83.27**	**2.11**	**0.80**	**0.0**	**124.38**	**7.48**	**930.0**

† Regimes beyond model validity ceiling (> 125°C). Linux Ondemand experiences thermal runaway under positive subthreshold leakage feedback, reaching 412.30 °C and dissipating an unphysical average of 302.5 W. This regime represents numerical extrapolation failure and is strictly excluded from quantitative reliability and performance inferences. Overshoot to 86.06 °C in Throttling 85/75 stems from sampling latency and sensor noise.

Table 4
Statistical Dispersions across 10 Stochastic Sensor Noise Seeds (Seeds 0 to 9)

Metric	Throttling 85/75	Space-PID	TCAS-DVFS
$T_{\max}$ (°C)	85.89 ± 0.15	85.54 ± 0.04	$\mathbf{83.25 \pm 0.03}$
$t_{>85}$ (s)	213.5 ± 15.7	14.6 ± 0.7	$\mathbf{0.0 \pm 0.0}$
ΔT_{peak} (K)	9.48 ± 0.09	4.86 ± 0.02	$\mathbf{2.10 \pm 0.02}$
ΔT_{mean} (K)	5.26 ± 0.13	0.617 ± 0.001	$\mathbf{0.795 \pm 0.001}$
FPS	119.70 ± 0.35	123.24 ± 0.00	$\mathbf{124.38 \pm 0.00}$
$E_{t_{\text{frame}}}$ (kJ·s/frame)	7.566 ± 0.024	7.469 ± 0.000	$\mathbf{7.477 \pm 0.000}$
Energy (kJ)	905.6 ± 0.3	920.46 ± 0.01	$\mathbf{929.95 \pm 0.01}$

s/frame). Relative to simple uncoordinated TCA-DVFS (116.16 FPS, 8.027 kJ · s/frame), the constrained MPC controller delivered a +7.1% throughput boost and a 6.8% reduction in $E_{t_{\text{frame}}}$, demonstrating the practical efficacy of active multivariable coordination.

Table 4 details performance across 10 independent stochastic noise seeds. EKF filtering maintains maximum temperature dispersion to within ± 0.03 K in TCAS-DVFS, compared to ± 0.15 K for Throttling.

6.2. Thermal Dynamics and Gradient Suppression

Figs. 4, 5, and 6 illustrate the orbital transient responses. While Throttling induces saw-tooth oscillations near 10 K and Space-PID exhibits gradient excursions during daylight transitions ($\Delta T_{\text{peak}} = 4.88$ K), TCAS-DVFS dampens mean gradients to 0.80 K and peak gradients to 2.11 K (a 77.6% reduction relative to Throttling). Operating temperatures remained above 83 °C for 57.7% of the orbital period (9,818 s out of 17,004.5 s), confirming that the predictive controller deliberately tracks the upper thermal boundary to maximize compute throughput.

6.3. Functional Ablation Study

The ablation results in Table 5, re-evaluated across 3 full orbits for methodological consistency, isolate the architectural mechanisms:

- **Dominant observed contribution of MPC-DVFS in the tested configuration:** removing the MPC controller (*Without MPC*) immediately leads to thermal threshold exceedance, accumulating 1,732.0 s above 85 °C, a peak of 85.48°C, and a tripling of peak gradient to 7.47 K. Dynamic lookahead within the MPC is the primary driver of proactive containment.

- **Limited observed benefit of SDP scheduling for the tested $N = 4$ configuration:** the *Without SDP* variant (static task assignment) achieves performance essentially identical to the full framework (83.24°C, 125.16 FPS, 7.435 kJ · s/frame). The SDP allocator performed 262 task migrations and matched the ex-post optimal discrete permutation in 49 of 142 calls (34.5%). In small symmetric configurations ($N = 4$), conductive cross-coupling is spatially uniform, rendering topological remapping largely ineffective. Whether topology-aware scheduling becomes beneficial for larger and less symmetric arrays remains an open question.

- **No material difference observed at the reported precision for the tested horizons:** varying prediction horizon $H_p \in \{10, 30, 60\}$ steps (corresponding to physical lookahead intervals of 20.0, 60.0, and 120.0 s under $\Delta t_{\text{MPC}} = 2.0$ s) produced identical performance metrics (124.38 FPS, 7.477 kJ · s/frame). This enables adopting shorter horizons ($H_p = 10$) to minimize onboard processor utilization.

6.4. Parametric Sensitivity Analysis (Latin Hypercube Sampling, $n = 30$)

To rigorously assess sensitivity against manufacturing dispersions and environmental deviations, a 30-sample Latin Hypercube Sampling (LHS) campaign was conducted (3 full orbits per sample, evaluating 1,020,270 integration steps) with simultaneous continuous uniform perturbations of $\pm 20\%$ across R_{ij}, R_r, c_i, and C_{rad} forming a parametric stress-test envelope.

No thermal-threshold violations were observed in the 30 sampled uncertainty realizations ($0/30$ samples > 85°C). By the exact Clopper-Pearson method, the two-sided 95% confidence upper bound for violation probability is **11.57%**. Thus, while the campaign demonstrates robust containment

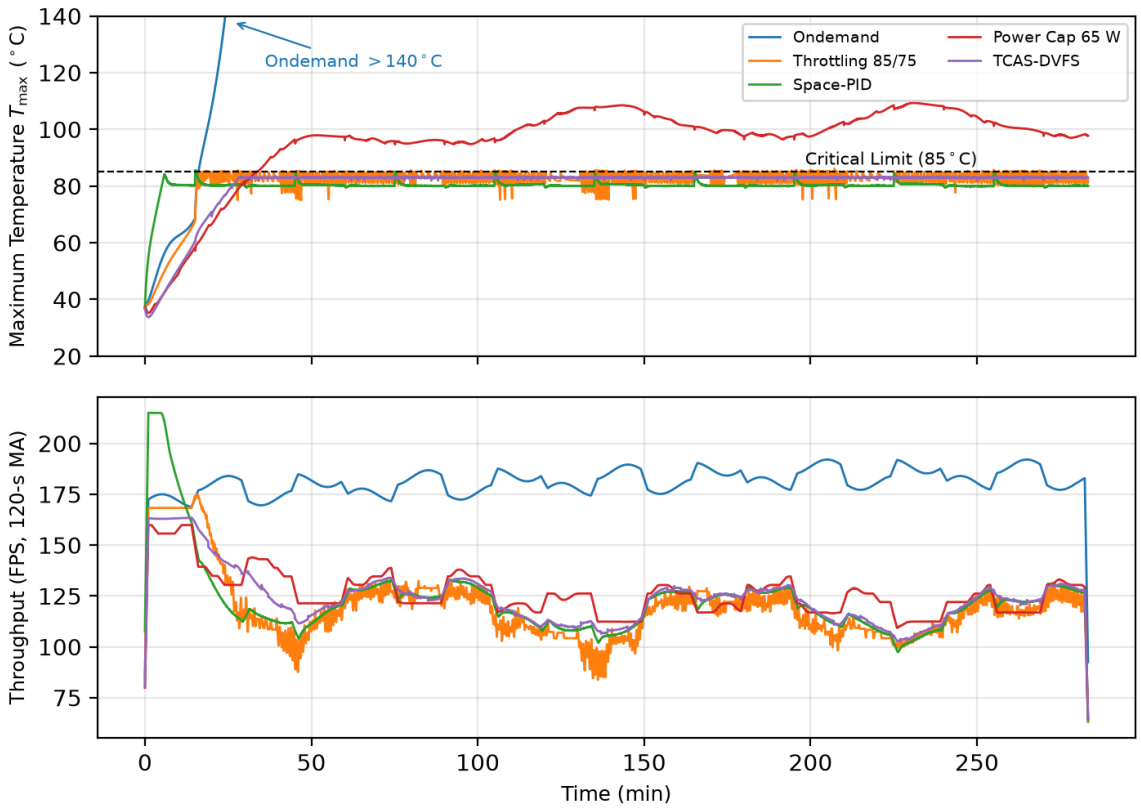


Figure 4: Temporal co-simulation dynamics over 3 complete orbits (seed 0): (a) maximum silicon junction temperature ($T_{\max}$), demonstrating strict compliance of TCAS-DVFS below 85 °C versus saw-tooth hysteresis in Throttling; (b) aggregate AI inference throughput smoothed with a 120 s moving average.

Table 5
Functional Ablation Study of TCAS-DVFS (3 Orbits, Seed 0)

Variant	$T_{\max}$ (°C)	ΔT_{peak} (K)	ΔT_{mean} (K)	FPS	$E_{t_{\text{frame}}}$ (kJ·s/frame)	$t_{>85}$ (s)
Full ($H_p = 30$, 60.0 s)	83.27	2.11	0.80	124.38	7.48	0.0
Without SDP	83.24	2.01	0.75	125.16	7.44	0.0
Without MPC	85.48	7.47	0.98	112.76	8.45	1,732.0
$H_p = 10$ (20.0 s)	83.27	2.10	0.80	124.38	7.48	0.0
$H_p = 60$ (120.0 s)	83.27	2.11	0.79	124.38	7.48	0.0
Simple TCA	83.74	1.58	0.45	116.16	8.03	0.0

within the sampled envelope, it does not establish a zero underlying violation probability (in contrast to Throttling 85/75, which violated thresholds in 100% of samples with a mean violation time of 234.8 s).

In paired comparisons under identical physical parameters:

(i) *Versus Throttling 83/73*: TCAS-DVFS reduced peak temperatures by 0.63 K (95% CI: $[-0.75, -0.50]$ K) and improved inference throughput by $+5.26\%$ (95% CI: $[+4.60\%, +5.91\%]$). The EDP delta was -0.36% (95% CI: $[-0.89\%, +0.18\%]$); because this interval crosses zero, **we make no claim of strict EDP superiority under uncertainty against Throttling 83/73**.

(ii) *Versus Throttling 85/75*: TCAS-DVFS reduced peak temperature by 2.66 K, raised throughput by $+4.38\%$, and achieved an EDP reduction of -1.77% (95% CI: $[-2.31\%, -1.23\%]$).

Within the sampled four-parameter uncertainty space, R_r exhibited the strongest monotonic association with $T_{\max}$, with Spearman rank correlation $\rho = +0.994$, followed by die heat capacity c_{die} ($\rho = -0.350$), radiator capacitance C_{rad} ($\rho = -0.220$), and inter-die crosstalk resistance R_{ij} ($\rho = -0.147$).

7. Indicative Reliability and Physical Degradation Assessment

All reliability projections utilize thermal histories after discarding the initial 2-hour transient warm-up phase, and are presented strictly as indicative comparative proxies.

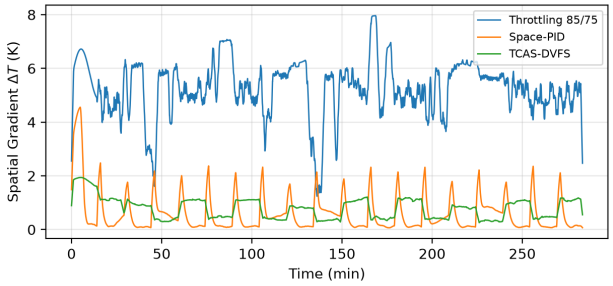


Figure 5: Temporal evolution of inter-die spatial thermal gradient ($\Delta T_{esp}(t) = \max_i T_i - \min_i T_i$) with a 120 s moving average: active suppression of conductive crosstalk by TCAS-DVFS.

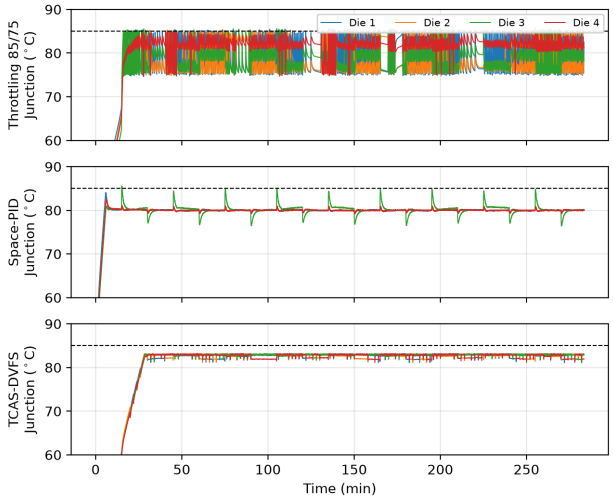


Figure 6: Individual junction temperature profiles for the 4 silicon dies (seed 0): homogeneous convergence under coordinated TCAS-DVFS versus spatial divergence under classical baselines.

7.1. Electromigration (Black's Equation Damage Proxy)

A relative Black-equation damage-rate proxy was computed from the simulated electrical-power and junction-temperature histories (Black, 1969):

$$\mathrm{MTTF}_{EM} \propto J^{-n} \exp\left(\frac{E_{a,EM}}{k_B T_j}\right), \tag{27}$$

where $n = 1.8$, $E_{a,EM} = 0.70$ eV, and current density is approximated by the normalized electrical current $J \propto P/V$. Time-integral accumulation over 3 orbits yielded relative MTTF proxy ratios ($\mathrm{MTTF}_{prop}/\mathrm{MTTF}_{ref}$) of **0.96** (aggregate dies) and 1.52 (worst die) versus Throttling 85/75; and **0.81** and 1.33 versus Throttling 83/73. Because TCAS-DVFS draws +7.6% and +9.9% higher average current due to sustained workload execution, we formally conclude that **the framework provides no net electromigration life extension**.

Table 6
Rainflow Cycle Counting and Relative Fatigue Damage Severity Ratios ($q = 2.1$, Aggregate Dies)

Threshold (ΔT)	Cycles Throttling	Cycles TCAS-DVFS	Damage Ratio ($D_{\mathrm{thr}}/D_{\mathrm{prop}}$)
0.25 K	741	377	190.8
1.00 K	724	104	251.8
2.00 K	612	20	1,068.1

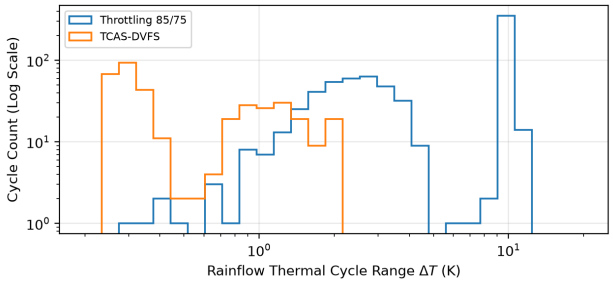


Figure 7: Rainflow thermal cycle range spectrum (ΔT, 0.25 K threshold after warm-up): TCAS-DVFS suppresses nearly all damaging cycles ($\Delta T > 2$ K).

7.2. Thermomechanical Solder Fatigue (Coffin-Manson Cyclic Severity)

Cumulative low-cycle thermal cycling severity in SAC305 solder interconnects is estimated using the Coffin-Manson relation (Manson, 1966):

$$N_f = B\,(\Delta T_{cycle})^{-q}, \quad q = 2.1. \tag{28}$$

Applying a three-point rainflow algorithm formally validated against the standard test sequences of ASTM E1049-85 (Section 5.4.4) and synthetic benchmarks to confirm exact peak-to-peak range counting ($\Delta T = T_{\mathrm{peak}} - T_{\mathrm{valley}}$), the maximum cyclic thermal excursion after transient warm-up dropped from 11.2 K (Throttling) to 2.12 K (TCAS-DVFS).

As shown in Table 6 and Fig. 7, eliminating large thermal excursions ($\Delta T > 2$ K) noticeably slows theoretical cyclic fatigue accumulation. However, junction temperature serves strictly as an indicative proxy for thermal cycling amplitude severity, rather than viscoplastic shear strain in actual solder joints. Comprehensive finite-element thermo-mechanical analysis remains required for flight qualification.

8. Related Work

Dynamic Thermal Management (DTM) in terrestrial multi-core architectures has been extensively investigated using tools such as HotSpot (Skadron et al., 2004; Brooks and Martonosi, 2001). 3D floorplanning (Lin et al., 2021), distributed task migration (Ge et al., 2010), and convex frequency optimization (Murali et al., 2007) advanced thermal regulation under convective conditions. In the aerospace domain, autonomous execution was validated by Sherwood et al. (2003), while advanced packaging models were proposed by Wang et al. (2025), and GPU orbital thermal

Table 7
Positioning against Closely Related Prior Work

Work	Sched.	Pred. DVFS	EKF	T^4 + Ecl.
Murali et al. (2007)	No	Static	No	No
Yuan et al. (2025)	No	No	No	Empirical
Chen et al. (2026)	Yes	No	No	No
This Work	**Yes**	**LTV MPC**	**Yes**	**Yes**

behavior was characterized by Yuan et al. (2025). The closest prior work is by Chen et al. (2026), which formulated thermal crosstalk scheduling. Table 7 positions our contribution relative to the state of the art.

9. Practical Implementation Considerations and Threats to Validity

9.1. Implementation Constraints

Deploying TCAS-DVFS on spaceborne flight computers requires addressing real-time execution constraints:

1. **Execution Complexity:** Embedded execution time, memory footprint, and worst-case timing remain to be benchmarked on flight-representative hardware. The warm-started ADMM-style iteration operates with a fixed cap of 60 iterations and early exit monitoring to prevent execution overruns.
2. **Memory Footprint:** The complete EKF covariance matrices, discrete prediction models, and warm-start vectors require modest scratchpad memory fitting within typical rad-hard microcontrollers.

9.2. Threats to Validity

As a model-based numerical investigation, several limitations must be explicitly recognized:

1. **Absence of Physical and Environmental Testing:** The findings rely entirely on numerical simulation of the stated lumped-parameter thermal network and have not been validated via Hardware-in-the-Loop (HIL) testbeds or Thermal Vacuum (TVAC) chamber testing.
2. **Lumped Modeling vs. Continuum Physics:** While the 5×5 CTM captures inter-die conductive coupling and bulk radiator dynamics, it does not resolve spatial micro-gradients across silicon dies, localized hot spots, or three-dimensional heat spreader diffusion.
3. **Throughput and Reliability Proxies:** Workload throughput is evaluated via a linear frequency proxy rather than cycle-accurate kernel profiling. Similarly, Black's equation and Coffin-Manson models are indicative proxies based on temperature histories rather than direct measurements of current density or plastic strain.
4. **Omission of Space Radiation Effects:** The present study focuses strictly on electrothermal dynamics and does not model Single Event Effects (SEE) or Total Ionizing Dose (TID), which can affect DVFS stability and memory integrity in orbital environments.

10. Conclusions

This paper presented TCAS-DVFS, a predictive control framework designed to mitigate spatial thermal crosstalk in high-density spaceborne AI clusters operating in deep orbital vacuum. The conclusions of this model-based numerical study are delineated into three levels:

1. **Demonstrated in the nominal model:** Integrated EKF state estimation, temperature-referenced radiative power budgeting, and discrete LTV MPC-DVFS produced zero observed thermal violations above the 85 °C flight threshold over 3 complete simulated LEO orbits (17,004.0 s), attenuated peak inter-die spatial gradients by 77.6%, and sustained 124.38 FPS. Ablation indicates a dominant contribution from the predictive control formulation in damping gradients and bounding temperatures, while topological SDP allocation provided limited observed benefit in compact $N = 4$ arrangements.
2. **Observed under parametric sensitivity sampling:** Under a $\pm 20\%$ Latin Hypercube Sampling stress-test envelope ($n = 30$), zero thermal violations were observed, yielding a 95% Clopper-Pearson exact upper bound of 11.57%. Sensitivity was heavily dominated by die-to-radiator thermal resistance (R_r, Spearman $\rho = +0.994$).
3. **Unverified physically:** The reported evidence is limited to numerical simulation. Physical service life, flight qualification, TVAC chamber behavior, and radiation tolerance remain unverified and constitute mandatory steps for future experimental development.

CRediT Authorship Contribution Statement

Dafnhê T. C. M. Barros: Conceptualization, Methodology, Software, Validation, Formal analysis, Investigation, Data curation, Writing - original draft. **Flávio B. Braz da Silva:** Supervision, Project administration, Resources, Writing - review & editing.

Declaration of Competing Interest

The authors declare that they have no known competing financial interests or personal relationships that could have appeared to influence the work reported in this paper.

Declaration of Generative AI and AI-Assisted Technologies in the Writing Process

During the preparation of this work, the authors used Anthropic Claude and Google Gemini in order to assist with English language stylistic editing, simulation script refactoring, and conceptual visual rendering of orbital geometry and thermal crosstalk (Figs. 1 and 2). After using these tools, the authors reviewed and edited the content as needed and take full responsibility for the content of the publication.

Data Availability

All simulation source code, execution pipelines, nominal parameter manifests, co-simulation logs, and computational reproducibility metadata are openly available in the GitHub repository at https://github.com/dafnhe-thor-barros/TCAS-DVFS.

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